



Safe use of chemicals

Our work with suppliers to improve health and safety in the workplace includes taking action on the use of process chemicals. We are reducing exposure to potentially harmful process chemicals through our [Chemical Use Policy](#). We have also developed [Guidelines for Management of Manufacturing Process Chemicals](#) to help suppliers implement best practices for managing chemicals that pose environmental or health risks. In addition, we surveyed 72 suppliers to understand and monitor chemical use in our supply chain.

Dell also collaborates with the [Clean Electronics Production Network](#) (CEPN) to advance IT industry efforts to protect supply chain workers from potentially harmful process chemicals. CEPN is comprised of over 20 member organizations including electronics brands and suppliers, environmental NGOs, labor and worker representatives, ecolabels and representatives from academia and government agencies. Our ongoing involvement with CEPN includes active participation in the Worker Engagement and Process Chemical Reporting workgroups, and Dell is a founding signatory and one of four companies to commit to the Toward Zero Exposure program.

The Toward Zero Exposure program:

- Creates a road map for process chemical management informed by suppliers, nongovernmental organizations and subject matter experts.
- Supports companies in assessing the use of process chemicals, strengthening the culture of worker safety and engagement, reducing worker exposure to identified priority chemicals and substituting them with safer alternatives.
- Measures and reports outcomes, expands the impact and reaches into deeper supply chain tiers.

Safe working conditions

In FY24, we continued the [TenSquared program](#) with eight of our suppliers. The TenSquared approach is one that engages a peer-elected team of supplier employees and managers who work together to identify root causes of workplace challenges and then identify innovative ways to resolve them, all within 100 days.

Each participating supplier brought its most challenging environmental, health and safety (EHS) management concerns to the TenSquared program. The topics from participating suppliers covered EHS hotspots, such as reducing fire risks in warehouse areas and reducing occurrences of accidents resulting in work injuries.

Each supplier formed a dedicated work team, including members from management and frontline workers, to proactively resolve these issues and achieve a preset goal within 100 days.

These proactive actions included:

- Conducting a worker survey to understand worker concerns, incidents and historical data collection, among others.
- Team brainstorming to identify risks, risk classification and assessment.
- Communicating with diverse stakeholders to encourage engagement and collect effective improvement suggestions.
- Ensuring support for improvements, including financial and technical support and production flexibility.
- Keeping on track with weekly team meetings to monitor improvement action and implementation progress.

- Attending program training events to build capability and conducting impact surveys among production workers to evaluate improvement, impact and achievements. These surveys also allowed opportunities to provide feedback on further improvements.
- Regularly engaging worker representatives and factory management representatives to review process chemicals.

Responsible minerals sourcing

Minerals are an important component of many Dell Technologies products. Some of these minerals are potentially mined in conflict-affected and high-risk areas. While we do not purchase minerals directly from mines, smelters or refiners, our expectations for responsible sourcing extend throughout our supply chain. It is our goal to purchase materials containing minerals whose mining and sale are aligned with our responsible sourcing commitments.

These commitments are underscored in the [Dell Responsible Sourcing Policy](#). We also coordinate with industry-wide groups such as the [Responsible Minerals Initiative](#) (RMI). A Dell sustainability leader sits on the RMI steering committee to further our commitments and actively drive progress. RMI, and organizations like it, promotes a common approach, tools and processes supporting sourcing decisions that drive improved and consistent overall regulatory compliance.

Our responsible sourcing efforts focus on key “conflict minerals” (tin, tungsten, tantalum and gold — known as 3TG) and follow the recommendations established by the [Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development \(OECD\) Due Diligence Guidance](#). These include conducting risk assessments, assurance and transparent reporting. We also track other minerals of concern, including cobalt, used in lithium-ion batteries, and mica, used as an electrical insulator.

Our approach places an emphasis on identifying and assuring smelters or refiners (SORs) used to process material supplied by mines or mineral processors. This includes an independent, third-party assessment of management systems and sourcing practices to validate conformance with the [Responsible Minerals Assurance Process](#) (RMAP). The sector-wide RMAP standards meet the OECD Due Diligence Guidance requirements, the [Regulation \(EU\) 2017/821 of the European Parliament](#) and the [U.S. Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act](#). Dell annually files a [Conflict Minerals Disclosure](#) with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission.

Tracking conformance rates

To track conformance rates, we require suppliers who use 3TG within their supply chain to complete the Conflict Minerals Reporting Template. To extend our due diligence process, we have engaged with the RMI to use the Extended Minerals Reporting Template for suppliers using cobalt or mica.

Because the sourcing of minerals is an ever-changing landscape, we are committed to watching this space closely to protect the lives and health of the people in our supply chain.

Given the many supply chain tiers involved and the size of smelting and refining operations, multiple suppliers will likely include some of the same SORs in their reporting. Through the RMI, Dell encourages suppliers to promote SOR participation in third-party assurance programs to achieve conformance or remove them from their supply chains. More information is available in our [Conflict Minerals Disclosure](#).

